SUSE offers free Linux support to manufacturers of medical devices

Open source software company SUSE will help any organisation making medical devices to fight COVID-19. It is offering free support and maintenance for its SUSE Linux Enterprise Server (SLES) operating system and container technologies. These SUSE solutions are available immediately to help speed time to market for device manufacturers.

SUSE CEO Melissa Di Donato said, “The current global pandemic requires more from us than simply trying to survive as companies and individuals. We are determined to help others as much as we can, doing what we do best. We have cutting-edge open source technology and know-how that can help others in the fight to save lives, and we will share it immediately and without charge. Our customers, partners and communities know of and share our commitment to making a difference – and that extends to our neighbours and fellow human beings around the world.”

SUSE Linux Enterprise is an operating system that can be built into, and help run, various kinds of devices, hardware and appliances. SUSE Embedded Linux comes with an optimised system footprint for specific products, including medical devices, said sources at SUSE.

SUSE is also offering free support for its container and cloud technologies. This includes the SUSE CaaS platform, which allows companies to use Kubernetes to more easily deploy and manage container based applications and services. It also includes the SUSE cloud application platform, which offers an advanced cloud-native developer experience to Kubernetes, allowing companies to get applications to the cloud, as well as devices to market faster.

The company said that SUSE customers in the pharmaceutical and research space, along with national laboratories across the globe, are already using supercomputers running SUSE Linux Enterprise to find solutions to the issues posed by COVID-19. These include prevention, treatment, and cures.

Google open sources microcontroller modules named Pigweed

Google has open sourced Pigweed, a collection of microcontroller modules designed for developers using 32-bit devices. This was done to enable faster and more reliable development of microcontrollers.

Google had filed a trademark for Pigweed with the US Patent and Trademark Office in late January. Pigweed will offer tools that will offer a simplified setup through a virtual environment. The bootstrap script in Pigweed’s *pw_env_setup* module setup has access to a standardised set of utilities, which includes Python 3.8, clang-format, and an ARM compiler. It does this without modifying the system’s default environment.

Pigweed supports distributed testing, pre-configured code formatting, and integrated pre-submit checks. From the code editor, the *pw_watch* module provides a watcher that creates a build automatically when a file is saved. It runs the tests affected by the code changes to reduce the edit-compile-flash-test cycle for changes.

The Pigweed source is available under an Apache 2.0 licence. Google sources have said that Pigweed is still in early development, and is not recommended for production at this time.